M&A DEAL EXPERIENCE & ANALYST RESPONSIBILITIES HANDBOOK

A Transaction Reference & Professional Responsibilities Guide

Prepared for Om | August 2026

A note on sourcing and confidentiality

This handbook covers 14 transactions from a firm deal list. No personal workstream notes or involvement details were provided for any of these deals, so no section of this document claims or infers what you personally did on any specific transaction — every 'My Role' field is marked Not Provided. What this handbook does deliver in full is (1) publicly-sourced factual analysis of each transaction, built exclusively from public press releases, SEC filings, and reputable financial media, and (2) a comprehensive, generic explanation of what an M&A Analyst actually does across the deal lifecycle — sell-side, buy-side, take-private, merger, and spin-off — which you can use to speak knowledgeably about the transaction-execution process in general, independent of any specific deal.

Every factual claim below is drawn from public sources cited at the point of use and in the Sources section. Nothing about deal economics, process, or rationale has been invented; where public information was incomplete, this is stated explicitly.

Master Deal List

#	Client	Target/Buyer	Type	Side	Industry	Deal Size	Date
1	Meta Platforms	BlackRock (JV partner/financier)	JV + Bond Financing	Sell-Side	TMT	$14.3bn	7/28/26
2	RAFT	Leonardo DRS (Buyer)	Strategic Acquisition	Sell-Side	Industrials	$450mn	7/28/26
3	Ingredion	Tate & Lyle (Target)	Cross-border Acquisition	Buy-Side (Private)	Consumer	£3.7bn	6/8/26
4	FedEx	FedEx Freight (Spin-off)	Spin-off	Sell-Side	Industrials	$20bn+ implied	6/1/26
5	Astreya Partners	Cognizant (Buyer)	Strategic Acquisition	Sell-Side	TMT	~$600mn	4/29/26
6	Kashiv BioSciences	Amneal Pharmaceuticals (Buyer)	Strategic Acquisition	Sell-Side	Healthcare	$1,100mn	4/22/26
7	Veris Residential	Affinius Capital (Buyer)	Take-Private (REIT)	Sell-Side	Real Estate	$3.4bn	2/23/26
8	Mubadala Capital - FSG	Clear Channel Outdoor (Target)	Take-Private	Buy-Side (Negotiated)	TMT	$6.2bn	2/9/26
9	CVC Capital Partners	Marathon Asset Mgmt (Target)	Asset Manager M&A	Buy-Side (Negotiated)	FIG	$1,000mn	1/26/26
10	RAPT Therapeutics	GSK (Buyer)	Strategic Acquisition	Sell-Side	Healthcare	$2.2bn	1/19/26
11	OneStream	HgCapital (Buyer)	Sponsor Take-Private	Sell-Side	TMT	$6.4bn	1/6/26
12	Clearwater Analytics	Permira & Warburg Pincus (Buyers)	Sponsor Take-Private	Sell-Side	FIG	$8.4bn	12/21/25
13	Airbus (Satair)	Unical Aviation (Target)	Strategic Acquisition (Auction)	Buy-Side (Auction)	Industrials	Undisclosed	11/7/25
14	REV Group	Terex (Merger partner)	Stock + Cash Merger	Merger	Industrials	$9bn	10/30/25

Portfolio pattern summary

- Industry mix: Industrials (4), TMT (3), Healthcare (2), FIG (2), Real Estate (1), Consumer (1), plus one JV/financing deal spanning TMT/infrastructure
- Transaction type mix: strategic acquisitions (5), sponsor/PE take-privates (3), REIT take-private (1), asset-manager consolidation (1), spin-off (1), merger (1), JV/financing (1), auction-driven acquisition (1)
- Buy-side vs sell-side: 5 buy-side/negotiated engagements, 8 sell-side engagements, 1 merger (dual-sided by nature)
- Buyer type: mix of strategics (Leonardo DRS, Ingredion, Cognizant, Amneal, GSK, Airbus/Satair, Terex) and financial sponsors (Affinius Capital, Mubadala Capital/TWG, CVC, Hg, Permira/Warburg Pincus)

- This breadth — strategic and sponsor buyers, cross-border and domestic, public and private targets, and multiple deal structures (straight acquisition, take-private, spin-off, merger, JV) — reflects exposure across nearly every major M&A transaction archetype within a single deal list.

What an M&A Analyst Does Throughout the Deal Lifecycle

This is a generic, consolidated explanation of the M&A Analyst function — not tied to any specific deal on the list, since no personal workstream notes were provided. It is organized first by the overall deal lifecycle, then by transaction type, since an Analyst's actual day-to-day work differs meaningfully between a sell-side auction and a buy-side take-private.

The complete deal lifecycle

Origination/Mandate → Initial Analysis → Strategic Assessment → Valuation → Financial Modeling → Marketing Prep → Buyer Universe → Buyer Outreach → NDA → Teaser/CIM/Mgmt Deck → Buyer Engagement → Management Meetings → Indicative Bids → Due Diligence → Final Bids → Negotiation → Documentation → Signing → Regulatory Approval → Closing

Stage	What happens	Analyst's typical involvement
Origination/ Mandate	The bank is engaged by a client to advise on a sale, acquisition, or strategic alternative	Limited — origination is led by senior bankers; Analysts may support initial company/industry screening
Initial Analysis	Building a factual understanding of the company, its financials, and its market	Heavy — historical financial spreading, business overview drafting, industry research
Strategic Assessment	Framing why the transaction makes sense and for whom	Analyst supports with market sizing, competitive landscape, and precedent research; senior bankers own the narrative
Valuation	Building the range of value using multiple methodologies	Heavy — trading comps, transaction comps, DCF, and (on buy-side) LBO analysis
Financial Modeling	Building the operating model and transaction model	Heavy — this is core Analyst work; VPs/Associates review and stress-test
Marketing Prep	Building the materials that will be shown to buyers/investors	Heavy — teaser, CIM, management presentation drafting and iteration
Buyer Universe	Identifying and prioritizing who to approach	Analyst builds and maintains the list; senior bankers and client decide final targeting
Buyer Outreach / NDA	Making contact and getting confidentiality agreements signed	Analyst tracks and coordinates; senior bankers make the actual buyer calls
Buyer Engagement	Sharing materials, fielding initial questions	Analyst manages logistics and drafts responses for senior review
Management Meetings	Buyers meet company management	Analyst prepares materials and Q&A prep; does not typically lead client-facing sessions
Indicative Bids	Buyers submit non-binding offers	Analyst builds bid comparison analysis
Due Diligence	Buyers verify the business in depth	Heavy — Analyst coordinates the VDR, tracks Q&A, supports data requests
Final Bids / Negotiation	Binding offers and deal-term negotiation	Analyst supports with updated analysis; negotiation itself is led by senior bankers and lawyers
Documentation / Signing / Closing	Legal agreements finalized and executed	Analyst supports closing checklists and final materials; execution is legal/senior-

		banker-led

The consistent thread: Analysts own the underlying analytical work products (models, comps, materials, trackers) end-to-end, while senior bankers own client and buyer relationships, negotiation, and strategic judgment calls. Recognizing that distinction — 'owning an analytical workstream' versus 'managing a client/buyer relationship' — is itself a mark of professional maturity in how you describe the role.

Sell-Side M&A: Stage-by-Stage Analyst Responsibilities

Stage 1 — Initial Preparation

- Historical financial analysis: spreading 3-5 years of financials to understand growth, margin, and cash-flow trends before building forward projections
- Business overview and industry research: building the factual base the equity story and CIM will rest on
- Financial model: a detailed operating model forming the basis for management's plan and buyer diligence questions
- Valuation analysis (comps, precedents): establishing a credible value range before going to market — this disciplines both client expectations and marketing strategy
- Quality of Earnings review coordination: normalizing EBITDA for one-off items so the number being marketed is defensible under buyer scrutiny

Stage 2 — Buyer Universe Development

- Strategic buyers: companies in the same or adjacent industries with a logical rationale to own the asset
- Financial sponsors: PE firms whose existing portfolio, sector thesis, or fund mandate fits the target
- Geographic and adjacent players: buyers who could use the deal for market entry or capability expansion
- The buyer list is a living document — Analysts continuously refine it as buyer conversations reveal interest, disinterest, or new candidates

Stage 3 — Portfolio Mapping

- For financial sponsors specifically, mapping their existing portfolio reveals potential platform-fit (does this look like an add-on to something they already own?), competitive conflicts (do they own a direct competitor, making them unlikely to bid?), and thesis alignment (does this match their publicly stated sector focus?)
- This is one of the most valuable pieces of buy-side intelligence an Analyst produces — it turns a generic buyer list into a prioritized, rationale-backed outreach strategy

Stage 4 — Buyer Pages

- A buyer page is a one-page profile per prospective buyer: who they are, why they might be interested, their financial capacity, past relevant deals, and a first-cut view on their likely valuation appetite — used internally to prioritize outreach and prep senior bankers before buyer calls

Stage 5 — Marketing Materials

Document	Purpose	Analyst's typical contribution
Teaser	A 1-2 page anonymized summary to gauge initial buyer interest before an NDA is signed	Drafts and iterates language and key highlighted metrics
CIM (Confidential Information Memorandum)	The full marketing document shared post-NDA — business, financials, market, investment highlights	Owns the drafting process end-to-end; senior bankers and client shape the narrative and sign off
Management Presentation / FSG deck	Materials used in buyer management meetings	Builds the deck and prepares supporting Q&A materials
Financial model	The basis for buyer-facing projections and diligence questions	Builds and maintains; must be defensible under buyer scrutiny

Third-Party Diligence — Quality of Earnings & Market Study

- QoE examines normalized EBITDA, one-time items, revenue quality, and working capital trends — an Analyst typically coordinates with the third-party accounting firm, tracks findings, and ensures they're reflected consistently across the model and CIM
- A market study externally validates market size, growth, and competitive positioning — Analysts often synthesize this into the CIM's market section and buyer talking points
- Flow: Market Study/QoE → CIM → Buyer Analysis → Valuation → Due Diligence → Negotiations — each output feeds the next, so an error early (e.g., an unnormalized EBITDA figure) propagates through the entire process

NDA & Buyer Outreach

- Flow: buyer identification → outreach → NDA execution → information sharing. Analysts track NDA status across dozens of buyers simultaneously, manage buyer correspondence logs, and route information requests — supporting, not leading, the relationship, which senior bankers own

VDR (Virtual Data Room) Management

- A VDR is the secure online repository where diligence documents are shared with buyers under controlled access
- Analyst responsibilities: organizing the data room structure, managing document uploads and version control, setting buyer-specific access permissions, tracking Q&A, and maintaining confidentiality/data-room hygiene
- Why it matters: in a competitive auction, disorganized or slow VDR management directly damages buyer confidence and can measurably affect final bid quality — it's an operational function with real deal-value consequences

Buyer Interactions & Process Management

- Analysts support buyer calls, banker introduction calls, and management meetings logistically and analytically, but senior bankers lead the actual buyer conversations and relationship management
- The distinction that matters: Analysts own analytical workstreams (models, materials, trackers) end-to-end; they support, rather than run, the client- and buyer-facing process itself

Due Diligence

- As the process moves from marketing to diligence, buyers run financial, commercial, legal, tax, and operational workstreams in parallel
- Analyst support: fielding data requests, tracking Q&A, running the financial analysis buyers ask for, and flagging issues to senior bankers
- Diligence findings can move valuation, purchase price, deal structure, financing terms, indemnities, and completion conditions — this is where a clean or messy earlier process (QoE, model integrity, CIM accuracy) pays off or costs the seller

Buy-Side, Take-Private, Merger & Strategic Advisory Responsibilities

Take-Privates

- Target identification and strategic analysis, valuation (trading comps, transaction comps, DCF), premium analysis relative to unaffected share price, shareholder analysis, and — where financing is leveraged — LBO analysis and financing considerations
- Board materials supporting the target's fiduciary-duty process, and diligence support once exclusivity or a go-shop period narrows the field

Auctions (buy-side perspective)

- Bid strategy and analysis, competitive positioning versus other likely bidders, process tracking across bid rounds, financing structuring, and diligence prioritization given limited time in a competitive process

Negotiated Acquisitions

- Target analysis and valuation without a competitive auction dynamic — often allows deeper diligence before signing but requires the buyer to independently anchor value rather than relying on competitive tension

Mergers of Equals / Stock-and-Cash Mergers (e.g., the REV Group / Terex structure)

- The analytical approach differs meaningfully from a standard acquisition: relative valuation of both companies (not just the target), exchange ratio determination, pro forma ownership split, governance negotiation (board seats, management structure), and accretion/dilution analysis for both sets of shareholders — not just the buyer
- Relative shareholder value analysis is central: each side's board must be able to show its own shareholders they're receiving fair value relative to the other side, which is a fundamentally different negotiation dynamic than a single-buyer acquisition

Strategic Advisory

- Distinct from sell-side or buy-side execution: strategic advisory covers strategic-alternatives analysis, portfolio/divestiture analysis, acquisition strategy, industry consolidation mapping, and scenario/capital-allocation analysis — often without a live, named transaction attached
- The output is usually a recommendation or framework for the board/management team to act on, rather than an executed transaction — this is upstream of, and sometimes leads into, an actual sell-side or buy-side mandate

One-Page Deal Reference Sheets

Concise, publicly-sourced snapshots for each transaction. 'My Involvement' is marked Not Provided throughout, per your instruction that no personal workstream notes exist for these deals.

1. Meta Platforms / BlackRock — El Paso Data Center JV & Financing

Field	Detail
What happened	Meta and BlackRock formed a joint venture to build a 1-gigawatt, ~$14bn AI data center in El Paso, Texas; BlackRock funds hold an 80% interest, Meta 20%
Financing	BlackRock raised ~$12.3-12.5bn via a single bond issuance at a 7.5% yield, led by JPMorgan and Morgan Stanley, targeting pension funds, insurers, and endowments as buy-and-hold investors
Contributions	Meta contributed land and construction-in-progress assets valued at ~$2.3bn; BlackRock contributed ~$4.9bn cash at financial close
Rationale	Meta secures long-term data center capacity for AI workloads while moving the capital cost off its own balance sheet; BlackRock deploys infrastructure-style capital into a long-duration, investment-grade-adjacent bond structure
Status / Timeline	Facility targeted to go online in 2028 with Meta as sole tenant
My Involvement	Not provided

2. RAFT / Leonardo DRS

Field	Detail
What happened	Leonardo DRS agreed to acquire Raft LLC, a McLean, VA-based provider of AI-driven, multi-domain data fusion and mission software for defense customers, in an all-cash deal
Deal size	$450 million
Financing	Leonardo DRS expects to fund via cash on hand and revolving credit facility borrowings
Rationale	Expands Leonardo DRS's mission software, AI, and multi-domain data integration capabilities — increasingly central to modern defense platforms
Status / Timeline	Announced July 28, 2026; subject to regulatory approval; expected to close Q4 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

3. Ingredion / Tate & Lyle

Field	Detail
What happened	Ingredion made a recommended all-cash offer to acquire Tate & Lyle plc, a UK-listed global leader in mouthfeel, sweetening, and fortification ingredients
Deal size	~£3.7bn (~$5.0bn) implied enterprise value
Consideration	595 pence per share, a ~59% premium to Tate & Lyle's closing price the day before the approach became public; shareholders also entitled to specified dividends

Rationale	Creates a scaled global specialty-ingredients platform, broadening Ingredion's texturants, sugar-reduction, and fortification capabilities with complementary multi-ingredient systems and recipe-development expertise
Process/structure	UK court-sanctioned scheme of arrangement — the standard mechanism for a recommended, board-supported UK public company acquisition
Status / Timeline	Announced June 8, 2026; expected to close H2 2027 per public reporting
My Involvement	Not provided

4. FedEx / FedEx Freight Spin-off

Field	Detail
What happened	FedEx completed the spin-off of its Freight (less-than-truckload) segment as an independent, separately traded public company
Structure	Pro-rata distribution of 80.1% of FedEx Freight shares to FedEx shareholders (1 FDXF share per 2 FDX shares held); FedEx retained 19.9% of FedEx Freight
Ticker / listing	FedEx Freight began trading as 'FDXF' on the NYSE
Tax treatment	Structured to be tax-free to FedEx shareholders for U.S. federal income tax purposes
Rationale (per FedEx public materials)	Unlocks standalone value for the LTL freight business and creates a focused, independent leader in North American LTL, separate from FedEx's parcel/express operations
Status / Timeline	Completed June 1, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

5. Astreya Partners / Cognizant

Field	Detail
What happened	Cognizant agreed to acquire Astreya, a San Jose-based, platform-led AI-first IT managed services provider operating in 35+ countries
Deal size	~$600 million (not disclosed in the internal deal list; figure per public reporting)
Rationale	Expands Cognizant's AI infrastructure and managed-services capabilities at scale, leveraging Astreya's long-term relationships with six of the 'Magnificent Seven' hyperscalers
Status / Timeline	Announced April 29, 2026; expected close Q2 2026, subject to regulatory approval
My Involvement	Not provided

6. Kashiv BioSciences / Amneal Pharmaceuticals

Field	Detail
What happened	Amneal agreed to acquire Kashiv BioSciences, a biopharmaceutical company with R&D and manufacturing capabilities in complex generics, injectables, and biosimilars
Consideration	$375m cash + $375m equity at closing, plus up to $350m in additional milestone/contingent payments — total payment up to $1.1bn
Rationale	Combines Kashiv's R&D/manufacturing depth with Amneal's commercial strength ahead of a projected $300bn+ global biologics loss-of-exclusivity wave over the next decade, positioning for a steady cadence of biosimilar launches
Status / Timeline	Announced April 22, 2026; subject to shareholder approval; expected close H2 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

7. Veris Residential / Affinius Capital

Field	Detail
What happened	Veris Residential (a multifamily REIT) agreed to be acquired by an investor consortium led by Affinius Capital in partnership with Vista Hill Partners
Deal size	$3.4bn implied enterprise value at announcement (~$3.5bn at closing)
Consideration	$19.00 per share in cash — a 23.2% premium to the unaffected closing price and 27.5% premium to the 30-day VWAP
Rationale	Privatizes a sustainability-focused, Northeast-concentrated multifamily portfolio, allowing a private ownership structure to pursue development/repositioning without public-market reporting pressure
Status / Timeline	Announced February 23, 2026; unanimously board-approved; completed May 27, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

8. Clear Channel Outdoor / Mubadala Capital & TWG Global

Field	Detail
What happened	Clear Channel Outdoor agreed to be acquired (taken private) by Mubadala Capital in partnership with TWG Global
Deal size	$6.2bn enterprise value
Consideration	$2.43 per share cash — a 71% premium to the unaffected closing price
Financing	~$3bn of committed equity capital; debt financing secured from a group led by JPMorgan Chase Bank and Apollo Funds
Process	Included a 45-day go-shop period allowing Clear Channel to solicit competing offers before the window closed
Rationale	Provides financial flexibility and deleveraging support for an out-of-home media company, repositioning it for growth outside public-market constraints
Status / Timeline	Announced February 9, 2026; expected close Q3 2026, subject to regulatory approval
My Involvement	Not provided

9. Marathon Asset Management / CVC Capital Partners

Field	Detail
What happened	CVC Capital Partners agreed to wholly acquire Marathon Asset Management, a New York credit manager, rebranding it CVC Marathon
Deal size	~$1.0-1.2bn (figure varies slightly by source) plus performance-linked earnout
Consideration	$400m cash + up to $800m CVC equity at closing, plus up to $200m cash and $200m equity in earnout tied to FY2027-2029 performance
Rationale	Consolidates a global credit platform — combined ~€61bn in fee-paying AUM at close, with a stated ambition to more than double to ~€200bn by 2028
Leadership	Marathon co-founders Bruce Richards and Lou Hanover continue leading the credit strategies post-close
Status / Timeline	Announced January 26, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

10. RAPT Therapeutics / GSK

Field	Detail
What happened	GSK agreed to acquire RAPT Therapeutics, a clinical-stage biopharmaceutical company, primarily for its lead asset ozureprubart
Deal size	~$2.2bn aggregate equity value ($58.00/share cash); ~$1.9bn net of cash acquired
Key asset	Ozureprubart — a long-acting anti-IgE antibody in Phase 2 as a prophylactic treatment for food allergies, with a differentiated once-quarterly dosing profile
Rights scope	GSK receives global rights excluding mainland China, Macau, Taiwan, and Hong Kong
Rationale	Strengthens GSK's allergy/immunology pipeline with a potentially best-in-class, differentiated-dosing asset
Status / Timeline	Announced January 20, 2026; completed March 3, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

11. OneStream / HgCapital

Field	Detail
What happened	Hg agreed to take OneStream (a financial close/consolidation software company) private in an all-cash transaction
Deal size	~$6.4bn equity value
Consideration	$24.00 per share cash — a 31% premium to the prior close
Ownership post-close	Hg as majority voting shareholder; General Atlantic and Tidemark retaining minority positions
Context	OneStream had been taken public by KKR in 2024 — this transaction returns it to private ownership under a new sponsor
Status / Timeline	Announced January 6, 2026; completed April 1, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

12. Clearwater Analytics / Permira & Warburg Pincus

Field	Detail
What happened	Clearwater Analytics (investment accounting/analytics software) agreed to be acquired and taken private by a consortium of Permira and Warburg Pincus, with Francisco Partners and Temasek participating
Deal size	~$8.4bn transaction value
Consideration	$24.55 per share cash — a 47% premium to the undisturbed share price
Rationale	One of the largest fintech LBOs of the period; consortium structure spreads capital commitment and brings complementary sector expertise across the sponsor group
Status / Timeline	Announced December 21, 2025; completed June 25, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

13. Unical Aviation / Airbus (Satair)

Field	Detail
What happened	Satair, an Airbus company, agreed to acquire Unical Aviation and its subsidiary ecube — aircraft-parts and Used Serviceable Material (USM) suppliers
Deal size	Not publicly disclosed
Scale	Combined Unical/ecube 2024 revenue of ~$298m; 400+ employees across 7 sites in North America, Spain, and the UK
Rationale	Expands Satair's USM and aftermarket capabilities, complementing its 2022 acquisition of VAS Aero Services and extending Satair's engine/multi-fleet USM and end-of-life support offering
Status / Timeline	Announced November 7, 2025; completed May 11, 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

14. REV Group / Terex — Strategic Merger

Field	Detail
What happened	REV Group and Terex Corporation announced a strategic stock-and-cash merger, with Terex also announcing plans to exit its Aerials segment
Deal size	~$9bn implied enterprise value
Exchange terms	Each REV Group share converts into 0.9809 shares of the combined company plus $8.71 cash
Pro forma ownership	REV Group shareholders ~42%, Terex shareholders ~58% of the combined company
Combined financial profile	~$7.8bn net sales and ~11% Adjusted EBITDA margin (excluding synergies) as of year-end 2025
Synergies	$75m of run-rate synergies targeted by 2028, with ~50% expected within 12 months of closing
Rationale	Creates a larger, more diversified specialty equipment manufacturer while Terex simplifies its portfolio by exiting Aerials
Status / Timeline	Announced October 30, 2025; expected close H1 2026
My Involvement	Not provided

Deep-Dive Deal Analysis

Five transactions selected to represent the five distinct deal archetypes on the list: a spin-off, a sponsor take-private, a cross-border strategic acquisition, a strategic merger, and a sell-side pharma sale. Each is analyzed the way a deal-team professional would frame it, not summarized as a press release. Sections marked [Analytical Interpretation] go beyond what's publicly stated and are labeled accordingly.

Deep Dive 1: FedEx Freight Spin-off

Why did this happen?

- Strategic: separates a slower-growth, more cyclical, capital-intensive LTL trucking business from FedEx's core parcel/express operations, letting each be valued and run on its own footing
- [Analytical Interpretation] Financial: LTL businesses typically trade on different multiples than integrated logistics/express businesses — a standalone LTL pure-play can be benchmarked directly against comparable LTL carriers rather than being blended into a conglomerate discount
- Market: LTL freight has faced its own distinct competitive and pricing dynamics (e.g., post-Yellow Corp bankruptcy capacity shifts) that a focused management team may be better positioned to navigate than as one division of a larger parcel company

Transaction mechanics

- Pro-rata distribution of 80.1% of FedEx Freight shares to existing FedEx shareholders (1 FDXF share per 2 FDX shares); FedEx retained 19.9%, giving it a continuing minority economic interest while FedEx Freight trades independently
- Structured as tax-free to FedEx shareholders under U.S. federal tax rules — the standard structure for a value-accretive spin-off, since a taxable structure would trigger an immediate shareholder tax cost that erodes the value-creation rationale

What an investor/analyst would want to know next

- [Analytical Interpretation] Standalone capital structure: what debt, if any, was allocated to FedEx Freight at separation, and whether its balance sheet supports independent capex and cyclicality
- [Analytical Interpretation] Governance/overhang: FedEx's retained 19.9% stake could create a future overhang if FedEx later monetizes it — a factor market participants typically price in
- Not publicly disclosed in the sources reviewed: FedEx Freight's standalone financial guidance, initial trading multiple, or FedEx's stated intentions for its retained stake

Deep Dive 2: Clear Channel Outdoor — Mubadala Capital / TWG Global Take-Private

Why did this happen?

- Financial/strategic: a 71% premium to the unaffected price signals a company trading well below what a private owner believed the underlying out-of-home media assets were worth — often reflecting public-market skepticism about a leveraged, legacy-media-adjacent business that a private owner is better positioned to re-rate over a longer, non-quarterly time horizon
- [Analytical Interpretation] Deleveraging rationale: the ~$3bn of committed equity capital, explicitly described as supporting 'ongoing deleveraging efforts,' suggests the existing public capital structure was constraining the business — a classic take-private thesis where private ownership allows balance-sheet repair without public-market share-price pressure during the process

Process

- A 45-day go-shop period was built into the agreement — a standard governance mechanism letting the target's board solicit superior competing offers post-signing, protecting the board's fiduciary process and giving the market a real (if time-limited) chance to test the price
- Debt financing led by JPMorgan Chase Bank and Apollo Funds — a combination of a traditional bank lender and a credit-focused alternative asset manager, consistent with how large take-privates are increasingly financed via a blend of bank and private-credit capital

How I'd analyze this as an investment

- Business quality: out-of-home advertising has real barriers to entry (permitted physical sites, municipal contracts) but faces secular competition from digital advertising channels — a mixed quality profile
- [Analytical Interpretation] Leverage suitability: a highly-levered, cyclical-advertising-exposed business is a harder base for aggressive additional leverage — the equity-heavy financing structure (a large committed equity check relative to headline deal size) is consistent with a deliberately conservative capital structure post-close
- Key risks: continued secular share loss to digital advertising, interest-rate sensitivity given existing leverage, and execution risk in the deleveraging plan
- Not publicly disclosed: post-close leverage ratios, specific value-creation plan, or targeted hold period

Deep Dive 3: Ingredion / Tate & Lyle

Why did this happen?

- Strategic: creates a larger-scale specialty-ingredients platform combining Ingredion's existing texturants and sweetening capabilities with Tate & Lyle's complementary multi-ingredient systems and fortification expertise — a capability-and-scale acquisition rather than a pure cost-out consolidation play
- [Analytical Interpretation] Market rationale: the specialty-ingredients category has been consolidating as food/beverage manufacturers seek fewer, more capable suppliers who can deliver integrated solutions (e.g., sugar reduction + texture + fortification together) rather than single-ingredient point solutions — scale and breadth are increasingly competitive advantages in this category

Transaction mechanics

- Structured as a UK court-sanctioned scheme of arrangement — the standard mechanism for a recommended (board-supported), all-cash acquisition of a UK-listed company, as opposed to a contractual takeover offer; requires shareholder and court approval but offers more deal certainty once agreed than a hostile/contractual offer
- 595 pence per share represents a ~59% premium to the pre-approach price — a large premium that signals strong strategic conviction and a board-recommended (not contested) process

Cross-border considerations an Analyst would flag

- Regulatory: cross-border, sector-relevant food/ingredients consolidation can attract antitrust scrutiny in both UK/EU and any other jurisdictions where the combined entity has meaningful share
- FX: as a US acquirer paying in GBP for a UK target, currency movements between announcement and closing affect the USD-equivalent cost — the £3.7bn/$5.0bn quoted values reflect a specific FX snapshot date, not a fixed USD price
- Not publicly disclosed: post-close synergy targets or integration cost estimates

Deep Dive 4: REV Group / Terex — Strategic Merger

Why did this happen?

- Strategic: combines two specialty-equipment manufacturers into a larger, more diversified platform, while Terex simultaneously exits its Aerials segment — meaning this is as much a portfolio-reshaping move for Terex as a scale play for both companies
- Financial: the combined ~$7.8bn net sales and ~11% Adjusted EBITDA margin (pre-synergy) set a baseline the deal must improve on to be judged successful — the ~$75m run-rate synergy target by 2028 is the explicit value-creation commitment management is underwriting

Why this is structurally a merger, not an acquisition

- Both cash and stock consideration (0.9809 TEX shares + $8.71 cash per REV share), with REV shareholders retaining a substantial ~42% stake in the combined entity — this is a relative-value negotiation between two ongoing shareholder bases, not a clean-exit sale
- [Analytical Interpretation] This structure requires both boards to independently justify the exchange ratio and cash mix as fair to their own shareholders — the analytical process (relative valuation of both companies, not just the target) differs meaningfully from a single-buyer cash acquisition

Key risks and considerations

- Integration risk across two industrial manufacturers with distinct product lines and operating footprints
- Synergy execution risk — the $75m run-rate target is a specific, trackable commitment that the market will judge management against over the 2026-2028 period
- Terex's simultaneous Aerials exit adds transaction complexity — investors must evaluate the combined entity's forward shape, not just today's reported combined financials

Deep Dive 5: RAPT Therapeutics / GSK

Why did this happen?

- Strategic: GSK is buying a single, differentiated clinical-stage asset (ozureprubart) to strengthen its allergy/immunology pipeline — a targeted, thesis-driven biotech acquisition rather than a broad platform or commercial-revenue acquisition
- [Analytical Interpretation] The centerpiece asset's differentiated once-quarterly dosing (versus competitors requiring dosing every two-to-four weeks) is the core value driver — in specialty biotech M&A, a genuine product differentiation like dosing convenience can justify a premium valuation even pre-approval, because it directly affects real-world adherence and commercial potential

Deal structure & risk allocation

- An all-cash acquisition of equity ($58.00/share, ~$2.2bn aggregate, ~$1.9bn net of cash acquired) rather than a milestone/royalty-heavy structure — meaning GSK is taking on the full clinical and regulatory risk of the Phase 2 asset upfront, rather than sharing that risk with RAPT's existing shareholders via contingent payments
- Rights carve-out for mainland China, Macau, Taiwan, and Hong Kong — a common structure in biopharma M&A, reflecting either an existing regional licensing arrangement or GSK's own regional strategy for that specific therapeutic area

Why a financial investor's lens differs from a strategic acquirer's

- A strategic buyer like GSK can underwrite this deal on pipeline fit and commercial synergy with its existing immunology franchise — a financial sponsor would need to underwrite the asset purely on clinical/regulatory probability-of-success and standalone commercial economics, which is a much harder basis for an unapproved Phase 2 asset; this is part of why single-asset clinical-stage biotech M&A is dominated by strategic pharma buyers rather than PE sponsors
- Not publicly disclosed: RAPT's other pipeline assets' treatment in the transaction, or specific regulatory timeline assumptions underlying GSK's valuation

Deal Comparison Matrix & Patterns

Deal	Buyer type	Structure	Premium / basis	Interesting learning
Meta / BlackRock	Financial (infra capital)	JV + bond financing	N/A (JV, not acquisition)	Off-balance-sheet infra financing for AI capex via bond markets
RAFT / Leonardo DRS	Strategic	All-cash acquisition	Not disclosed	Capability acquisition (AI/data fusion) in defense tech
Ingredion / Tate & Lyle	Strategic	UK scheme of arrangement	~59% to pre-approach price	Cross-border, board-recommended UK public takeover mechanics
FedEx Freight	N/A (spin-off)	Pro-rata share distribution	N/A	Tax-free separation to unlock standalone LTL valuation
Astreya / Cognizant	Strategic	All-cash acquisition	Not disclosed	Services scale-up via capability/relationship acquisition
Kashiv / Amneal	Strategic	Cash + equity + earnout	N/A	Contingent consideration structure spreading risk across milestones
Veris Residential	Financial (RE consortium)	Take-private, all-cash	23.2% to unaffected price	REIT take-private consortium structure
Clear Channel Outdoor	Financial (sponsor consortium)	Take-private, all-cash	71% to unaffected price	Deleveraging-driven take-private with go-shop protection
Marathon / CVC	Financial (asset manager)	Cash + equity + earnout	N/A	Earnout-linked consideration in asset-manager consolidation
RAPT / GSK	Strategic (pharma)	All-cash acquisition	N/A (private-to-public via tender)	Single-asset, pipeline-driven biotech acquisition
OneStream / Hg	Financial (sponsor)	Take-private, all-cash	31% to prior close	Public-to-private-to-public-to-private cycle (KKR IPO → Hg take-private)
Clearwater / Permira & Warburg Pincus	Financial (consortium)	Take-private, all-cash	47% to undisturbed price	Multi-sponsor consortium spreading large-cap LBO capital need
Unical / Airbus (Satair)	Strategic	Acquisition from PE seller (auction)	N/A (deal size undisclosed)	Strategic buyer winning an auction from a financial sponsor seller
REV Group / Terex	Strategic (merger)	Stock + cash merger	N/A (relative-value negotiation)	Merger-of-equals-style relative valuation, not a clean sale

What these patterns reveal

- Sponsor-driven take-privates (Veris, Clear Channel, OneStream, Clearwater) dominate the list — reflecting an active 2025-2026 environment for public-to-private transactions, often at large premiums (31-71%) to unaffected prices, frequently financed through multi-party consortiums rather than single sponsors

- Strategic acquirers (Leonardo DRS, Ingredion, Cognizant, Amneal, GSK, Airbus/Satair) consistently pursue capability or scale acquisitions rather than pure financial roll-ups — each deal has a clearly articulated product, technology, or market-access rationale
- Consideration structures vary meaningfully with risk allocation: all-cash for lower-uncertainty targets, cash-plus-earnout for asset managers and pharma targets where future performance is harder to underwrite upfront, and stock-plus-cash for the one true merger-of-equals-style transaction
- The presence of one spin-off, one merger, several take-privates, and several straight strategic acquisitions across just 14 deals demonstrates breadth across nearly the full spectrum of M&A transaction types in a single period

Quick Reference: M&A Concepts & Deal Lifecycle Cheat Sheet

Deal lifecycle in one line

Origination → Analysis → Valuation → Modeling → Marketing → Buyer Universe → Outreach → NDA → CIM → Diligence → Bids → Negotiation → Signing → Closing

Sell-side vs. buy-side vs. strategic advisory — the core distinction

	Sell-side M&A	Buy-side M&A	Strategic Advisory
Client	The seller	The buyer	Board/management, no live transaction required
Analyst's core output	CIM, buyer universe, VDR management	Target screening, valuation, LBO/DCF, diligence support	Portfolio/scenario analysis, strategic recommendations
Success metric	Maximizing price and certainty of close for the seller	Securing the target at the right price/structure for the buyer	A sound recommendation, whether or not a deal follows

Key terms to have instantly ready

- Take-private: acquisition of a publicly listed company, removing it from public markets, typically by a financial sponsor or sponsor consortium
- Scheme of arrangement: a UK court-sanctioned mechanism for a board-recommended acquisition of a public company, requiring shareholder and court approval
- Go-shop period: a contractual window after signing during which the target can solicit competing bids, protecting the board's fiduciary process
- Earnout: contingent consideration paid based on future performance, used to bridge valuation gaps or share risk on uncertain future outcomes
- Unaffected price: a company's share price before market speculation about a deal began — the standard premium benchmark, since it isn't already inflated by deal rumors
- Exchange ratio: in a stock merger, the number of acquirer shares issued per target share — the central negotiating point in any merger-of-equals-style deal

Sources

All facts in this handbook are drawn from the following public sources, current as of research date (August 2026). Figures and deal terms are subject to revision as transactions progress toward closing; verify current status via the primary sources below before relying on any figure.

- Meta/BlackRock: Bloomberg (Jul 20 & 28, 2026); Meta Investor Relations press release; Qz.com
- RAFT/Leonardo DRS: Leonardo DRS press release (Jul 28, 2026); GlobeNewswire; SEC EDGAR filing; Defense Daily
- Ingredion/Tate & Lyle: Ingredion SEC 8-K filings; FoodNavigator-USA; FoodInfoTech; Grafa
- FedEx/FedEx Freight: FedEx Investor Relations (2026); FedEx Freight Holding Co. SEC 10-K/8-K filings; BusinessWire
- Astreya/Cognizant: Cognizant Investor Relations (Apr 29, 2026); PRNewswire; SiliconANGLE
- Kashiv/Amneal: Amneal Investor Relations press release; GlobeNewswire; BioSpace; Goodwin Law insights
- Veris Residential/Affinius Capital: Veris Residential SEC 8-K filings; PRNewswire; IREI; The Real Deal
- Clear Channel Outdoor/Mubadala Capital: Clear Channel Investor Relations; Bloomberg; PRNewswire; Kirkland & Ellis press release
- Marathon/CVC: CVC Capital Partners press releases (cvc.com); Benzinga; FIN News
- RAPT Therapeutics/GSK: GSK press releases (gsk.com); RAPT Investor Relations; STAT News; PharmExec
- OneStream/Hg: Hg Capital insights (hgcapital.com); Bloomberg; OneStream SEC 8-K; CFO Dive
- Clearwater Analytics/Permira & Warburg Pincus: Permira press releases; Warburg Pincus press releases; CNBC; SEC DEF 14A filings
- Unical Aviation/Airbus (Satair): Airbus newsroom (airbus.com); Platinum Equity press release; AviTrader
- REV Group/Terex: Terex Investor Relations; Davis Polk deal summary; RVBusiness; SEC DEFM14A filing